# AI Evals for Designers: Quick Checklist

Five steps to find where your AI product goes wrong, using 20 real answers and a spreadsheet. About two hours, no code.

STEP 1

## Collect 20 real answers

Pull 20 real conversations or outputs from your product. Include the awkward ones: requests it cannot handle, missing information, things it should refuse.

About 20 min for 20 answers

FOR EXAMPLE

- **Support bot** — Real tickets, including refund requests and an angry customer
- **Writing assistant** — Drafts from very short prompts and off-brand requests
- **Search or summary** — Questions with no good answer in the sources

STEP 2

## Mark each one pass or fail

Ask one question: would I be happy if a real user got this? When it fails, write one plain line on the first thing wrong. No scores and no categories yet.

About 40 min for 20 answers

FOR EXAMPLE

- **Support bot** — Fail: promises a refund it cannot issue
- **Writing assistant** — Fail: tone far too casual for a legal email
- **Search or summary** — Fail: summary leaves out the main caveat

STEP 3

## Group the notes and count

Sort the notes into piles the way you would affinity-map research. Count each pile. The biggest pile is your first problem.

About 20 min for 20 answers

FOR EXAMPLE

- **Support bot** — Claims actions it cannot take
- **Writing assistant** — Ignores the requested tone
- **Search or summary** — Drops important caveats

STEP 4

## Turn the biggest pile into one rule

Write it as a yes or no question that anyone on the team could apply to an answer and get the same verdict.

About 10 min for 20 answers

FOR EXAMPLE

- **Support bot** — Does it only promise actions the product can actually take?
- **Writing assistant** — Does the draft match the tone the user asked for?
- **Search or summary** — Does the summary keep every caveat from the source?

STEP 5

## Fix, then re-check the same 20 plus 5 new ones

Change one thing, rerun the same answers and apply the same rule. Add a few the fix never saw, so you know it works beyond the ones you tuned it on.

About 30 min for 20 answers

FOR EXAMPLE

- **Any product** — Count how many answers break the rule, before and after
- **Any product** — Read the new ones too: a fix can quietly break something else

# Review sheet

One row per answer. Mark pass or fail, write the first thing wrong in one line, then group the notes once all 20 are done.

| # | Input (what the user asked or did) | Output (what the AI said) | Pass / Fail | First thing wrong (one line) | Group |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | | | | | |
| 2 | | | | | |
| 3 | | | | | |
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| 20 | | | | | |